

Liv Russo

Where The Body Breaks and Blooms

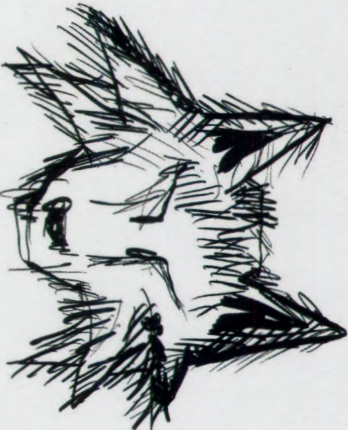
Daylight Savings

It was the first day of spring
The first day the sun told the moon she'd take a few hours off his shift.
She poured liquid gold across the sky and honey along the horizon.
Her warmth whispered a sweet song to the bluebirds outside,
And the first symphony of spring fluttered through the thick morning dew.
The bumblebees sweet-talked the rosebuds outside and left a basket of
kisses for the blossoms on the cherry trees.
, Skies of steel now painted in shades of gold,
Drizzled with butterscotch and dipped in hazelnut.
The sun shined through my window,
And for the first time,
I saw that I wouldn't be as dark
For as long as I believed

credits	
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medium	Poetry

I Carry a Bleeding Child Inside of Me; This is Her Voice

The Wolf



I write for you; I do everything for you
There is something so torn apart & stained inside of me that may be woven back together but will never be together again.

I carry a bleeding child inside my body and I don't know what to do with her pain.

I don't know where to put the puddle of tears she leaves in the back of my throat.

I hold her like a mouse in a cat's mouth and hunt her down like my prey so I don't have to bear the shame of a child's grief in the pit of my stomach.

I assume if I can sympathize with a living breathing thing, then it's the same as me.

If I can see humanity in their violence and salvage it, it feels less potent, less lethal.

I can sympathize with the hunter, even if I am their prey.

Sometimes, I worry the only tenderness I recognize is when it lives within violence.

Like the claw marks of a wolf left on a fawn after its kill.

Ripped open, exposed, and wounded.

Even in those gruesome, savage acts of violence, I still feel sympathy for the wolf- to tear open a soul so deeply, you rip apart and consume it entirely.

I think about the weight of tearing apart another creature and carrying its flesh in the back of your throat, how far anatomy can be pushed when deprived and starved.

I think about the wolf, whether it walked away in shame, satisfaction, or indifference.

I wonder if he was so vulgar with its prey because he was deprived, whether it was torn open so rabbinous because it struggled and fought for its life, or if it didn't fight back at all.

I wonder if every claw mark had to be there or if the wolf made it more gruesome than it had to be, simply because he knew he could.

I know this is primal, instinctual within us, I know this is a force of nature not similar to my own, so I won't make assumptions on something's soul because of a few lethal acts of violence, a couple brutal blows.

But I have my own claw marks that cling to my flesh and remind me that sympathy is a knife, and you only escape death once.